

RIGA NORDIC UNIVERSITY
of Applied Sciences

The Odin Project: Foundations

A free, open-source path from absolute beginner to web developer

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What is The Odin Project?

Free, open-source full-stack web development curriculum
Created by developers, maintained by the community
Project-based and self-directed — you learn by doing
Takes learners from zero experience to job-ready
No paywalls, no subscriptions — completely free

Course Philosophy

LEARN BY BUILDING — EVERY SECTION ENDS WITH A PROJECT

STRUGGLE IS PART OF THE PROCESS — CONFUSION IS WHERE LEARNING HAPPENS

ASK FOR HELP — THE DISCORD COMMUNITY IS ACTIVE AND WELCOMING

MINDSET MATTERS — CONSISTENCY BEATS INTENSITY

NO HAND-HOLDING — YOU ARE EXPECTED TO RESEARCH AND PROBLEM-SOLVE

Curriculum Overview

- The Foundations course has four major phases:
- Introduction & Setup — getting your environment ready
- HTML Foundations — building page structure
- CSS Foundations — styling and layout
- JavaScript Basics — making pages interactive

Phase 1: Introduction & Setup

How the web works — clients, servers, DNS, HTTP

Installations — Node.js, Git, and required tools

Text editors — setting up VS Code

Command line basics — navigating your file system

Setting up Git — version control from day one

Git basics — init, add, commit, push

Join the Odin community — Discord

Phase 2: HTML Foundations

1. Elements and tags — the building blocks of every page
2. HTML boilerplate — the standard page template
3. Working with text — headings, paragraphs, emphasis
4. Lists — ordered and unordered
5. Links and images — anchor and img tags
6. Commit messages — writing clear, descriptive Git commits
7. Project: Recipes — a multi-page recipe website

Phase 3: CSS Foundations & Flexbox

Intro to CSS — selectors, properties, values

The Cascade — how CSS decides which rule wins (specificity, inheritance, order)

Inspecting HTML and CSS — using browser DevTools

The Box Model — content, padding, border, margin

Block and inline elements — how elements flow on the page

Flexbox — axes, growing/shrinking, alignment (justify-content, align-items)

Project: Landing Page — a complete page layout using Flexbox

Phase 4: JavaScript Basics

Variables and operators — let, const, arithmetic, comparison, logical

Installing Node.js — running JavaScript outside the browser

Data types and conditionals — strings, numbers, booleans, if/else, switch

Functions — declarations, expressions, parameters, return values

Problem solving — pseudocode, breaking big problems into small ones

Understanding errors — reading stack traces

Project: Rock Paper Scissors — a console-based game

Phase 4: DOM, Objects & Final Project

- CLEAN CODE — MEANINGFUL NAMES, SMALL FUNCTIONS, DRY PRINCIPLE
- LOOPS AND ARRAYS — FOR, WHILE, MAP, FILTER, FOREACH
- DOM MANIPULATION — QUERYSELECTOR, CREATEELEMENT, TEXTCONTENT
- EVENTS — ADDEVENTLISTENER, CLICK, KEYBOARD, MOUSE
- REVISITING ROCK PAPER SCISSORS — ADDING A CLICKABLE UI
- PROJECT: ETCH-A-SKETCH — AN INTERACTIVE DRAWING GRID
- OBJECT BASICS — PROPERTIES, METHODS, THIS
- PROJECT: CALCULATOR — A FULLY FUNCTIONAL CALCULATOR

After Foundations & Tips for Success

WHAT COMES AFTER:

INTERMEDIATE HTML & CSS, ADVANCED JAVASCRIPT (ASYNC, APIS, TESTING)

REACT OR NODE.JS TRACK, DATABASES, FULL-STACK PROJECTS, JOB PREP

FOUNDATIONS: ~3–6 MONTHS • FULL CURRICULUM: ~6–12 MONTHS

TIPS FOR SUCCESS:

BUILD EVERY PROJECT YOURSELF • USE GIT FROM DAY ONE

ASK QUESTIONS IN DISCORD — BUT TRY TO SOLVE FIRST

READ ERROR MESSAGES • DEBUG WITH DEVTOOLS

DON'T TUTORIAL-HOP • DON'T SKIP THE STRUGGLE